



Funding and Growth Strategy

A partnership and funding pathway for CANCOM

Prepared by First Nations Procurement Inc. · Draft for discussion · June 2026

The opportunity, and why it runs through FNPI

Indigenous procurement is now required, with federal departments allocating 5% of contracts to Indigenous businesses. With targeted AI-drone funding and Defence building its domestic supply chain, Canada supports Indigenous economic growth. Public Services & Procurement Canada and major buyers face greater scrutiny to verify Indigenous business status before awarding contracts.

CANCOM is an established security services provider, and developer of cognitive autonomous monitoring Systems (CAMS), and advanced target acquisition. However, the business needs an Indigenous-led plan with verified ownership and corporate structure—this is where First Nations Procurement Inc. (FNPI) excels. FNPI is 100% First Nations owned and operating since 2017 from Sagamok Anishnawbek First Nation. It is registered with Indigenous Services Canada, CCAB, and the First Nations Procurement Authority directories, providing a compliant framework for establishing CANCOM as being market ready.

First Nations Procurement Inc., can assess, structure and build compliance so CANCOM becomes fundable and procurable through channels it cannot reach alone. Without a genuine Indigenous lead, the Indigenous-stream funding and set-asides described in this document are simply closed. **FNPI opens the doors, CANCOM brings the capability, and together the venture is both fundable and legitimate.**

Why this only works with a genuine Indigenous lead

The Indigenous-stream funding and set-asides in this plan are not open to a company that simply describes itself as Indigenous. They require the business to be at least 51 percent owned and controlled by Indigenous people, with real Indigenous value-add, and they are verified. The National Aboriginal Capital Corporations Association created the First Nations Procurement Authority specifically to verify Indigenous businesses and to stop arrangements where a non-Indigenous firm fronts through an Indigenous name.

A non-Indigenous company cannot self-declare into these streams, and attempting it risks bid forfeiture, contract termination, and disqualification. The only durable route is a genuinely Indigenous-majority structure led by a real Indigenous partner. FNPI provides exactly that: not a name on paper, but a real owner qualification, capability, and procurement infrastructure. Building the venture this way is not a constraint, it is what makes the funding real and the company defensible.

Recommended positioning

CANCOM-VigilAnt is an Indigenous-led JV technology and security enterprise. CANCOM provides Indigenous security expertise, while non-Indigenous partner contribute AI and cognitive



autonomous monitoring systems, delivering infrastructure evaluated by FNPI to governments, Indigenous communities, and key industry stakeholders. This collaborative structure qualifies CANCOM-VigilAI for the Indigenous and innovation funding outlined below.

Federal funding priorities

1. Indigenous Services Canada (ISC): entrepreneurship, procurement readiness, and capacity building.
2. NRC IRAP: AI platform development, drone autonomy, commercialization, and technical staffing.
3. Department of National Defence IDEAS: surveillance technologies, autonomous systems, AI-assisted monitoring, and ISR innovation.
4. Public Services and Procurement Canada (PSPC): Indigenous procurement and supplier engagement.

Ontario funding priorities

5. Ontario Centre of Innovation (OCI): AI development, commercialization, and technology partnerships.
6. Northern Ontario Heritage Fund Corporation (NOHFC): equipment, hiring, technology development, and expansion.
7. Invest Ontario: growth capital and commercialization support once pilots and customers are secured.

Recommended funding sequence

Phase 1 (0 to 3 months). FNPI establishes the framework for the venture's Indigenous-majority ownership and control structure as the prime, secure procurement registrations as the qualifying entity, finalize the brand and ownership agreement, prepare capability statements, and develop financial projections to access funding.

Phase 2 (3 to 6 months). Apply for IRAP, OCI, ISC, and NOHFC funding for AI and autonomous-systems development.

Phase 3 (6 to 12 months). Pursue DND IDEAS opportunities, launch Indigenous community pilot projects, and implement initial infrastructure deployments.

Positioning lines

- AI, security, and autonomous systems, Indigenous-owned and led.
- Human-directed, AI-supported, Indigenous-led.
- Sovereign technology for security, monitoring, and infrastructure.

The structure that qualifies



Ownership and control. At least 51 percent of the business owned and controlled by Indigenous people. Joint ventures require the same 51 percent Indigenous ownership and control.

Registration. To bid on federal set-asides, the business must be listed on the Indigenous Business Directory or a modern treaty business list. FNPI's registrations qualify the venture.

Evidence. Proof of ownership and control must be provided. Eligible structures include corporations, partnerships, cooperatives, and others, provided Indigenous owners hold final decision-making control.

Key recommendation

Shift from a partnership concept to a fundable, Indigenous-led technology company, founded on real ownership, products, intellectual property, commercialization, and measurable economic impact, with FNPI as the qualifying Indigenous operative and CANCOM as the technology and security capability partner.

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